TaskFlow | fix the leak before buying more growth

Genesis Strategy & Operations School 2.0
Case Task | March 2026

Recommendation

Do a focused turnaround.
The category still works; the value engine does not.

Loom

https://www.loom.com/share/ec723b4fa73542679c644feae340f941

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Included:
- deck
- PDF
- calculations
- source log

Operating rule:
No scale before D30 > 7% and paid churn < 14%.

Sources: Task brief and own analysis.

My read: this is a value leakage problem

The category is alive. TaskFlow stopped earning repeat usage.

What is broken

Retention is the clearest signal: D30 fell from 12% to 5%, D90 from 6.5% to 2.3%, and paid churn rose to 18%.

Why it broke

The product feels stale: no major release in 8 months, worse ratings, weak collaboration, no offline mode, repetitive UI.

Why this matters

Downloads and MAU fell 42%, CPI rose 44%, and burn is still about $150k a month against $60k MRR.

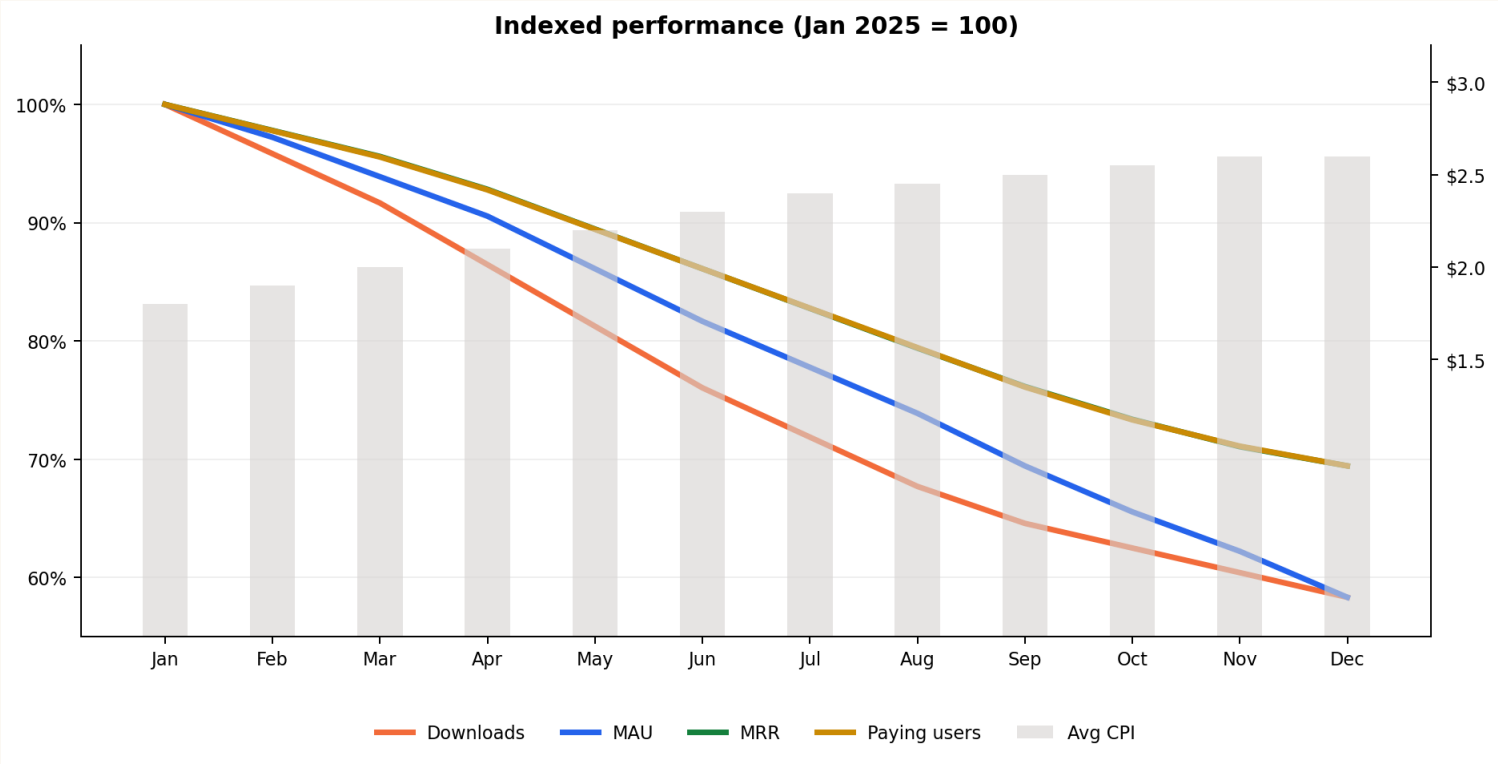
What management should do

Do not fund a full pivot yet. Narrow the promise, fix first-session value, and scale only after the core numbers move.

12-month objective: clear the retention gates, recover organic share, and reopen growth options.

Sources: Task brief; own calculations; Mordor; Gartner; competitor public pages.

The whole model bent in the same direction



Downloads

48k -> 28k
-42%

MAU

180k -> 105k
-42%

MRR

$86.4k -> $60.0k
-31%

Avg CPI

$1.80 -> $2.60
+44%

Sources: Task brief dataset; own calculations.

The leak starts after install

1. Retention broke first

Every cohort got weaker. D30 fell 58% and D90 fell 65% vs Q1 2024. That is what a value leak looks like.

2. The product stopped feeling fresh

Ratings fell from 4.6 to 4.2. Complaints repeat the same basics: weak collaboration, no offline mode, repetitive UI.

3. Paid growth became a patch

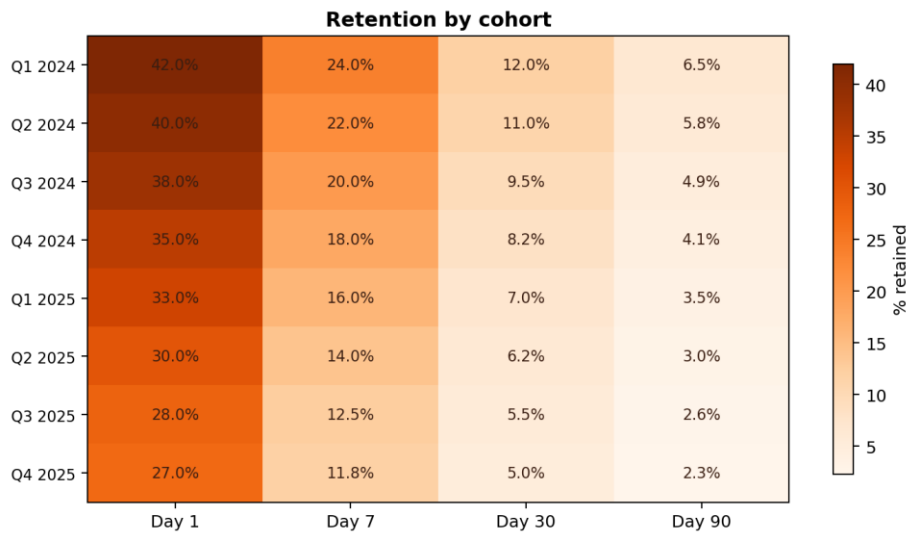
81% of installs are paid, and 62% come from Meta. That is too much dependence for a product with weakening retention.

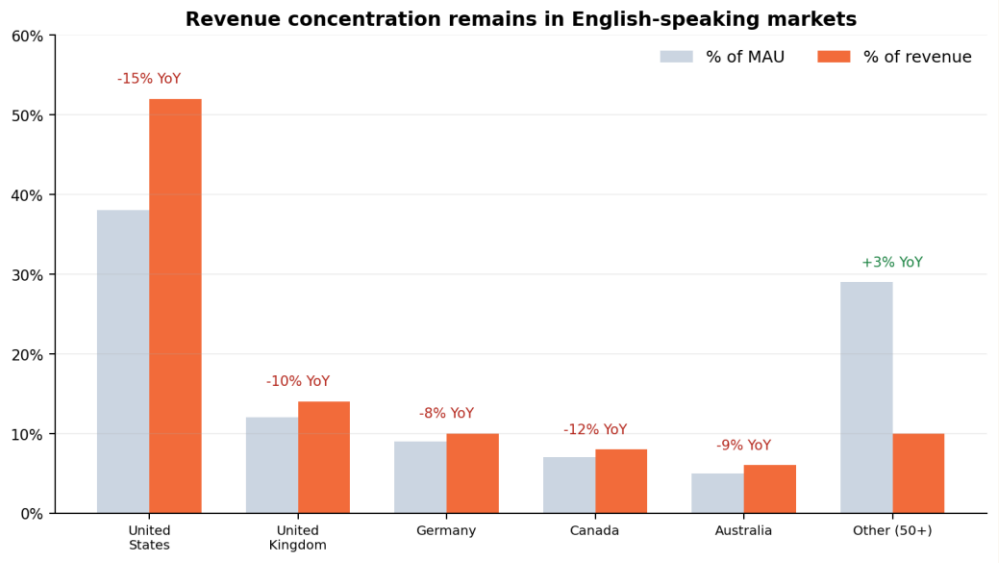
4. Cheap volume will not save it

Other markets are 29% of MAU but only 10% of revenue. Cheaper installs there do not repair the model.

Sources: Task brief dataset; public review themes from case prompt.

Paid growth is now almost a breakeven habit





Approx. paid CAC

$26.5
= $2.60 / 9.8%

Approx. paid LTV

$26.7
= $4.80 / 18%

So what?

At today's conversion and churn, a newly acquired payer barely covers expected subscription value.

Operator rule

Cap weak paid social. Shift energy into activation, retention, ASO and content until the model improves.

Sources: Task brief dataset; simplified LTV/CAC estimates using provided ARPPU, churn, CPI and free-to-paid conversion.

Three places where real growth still exists

The category is still real

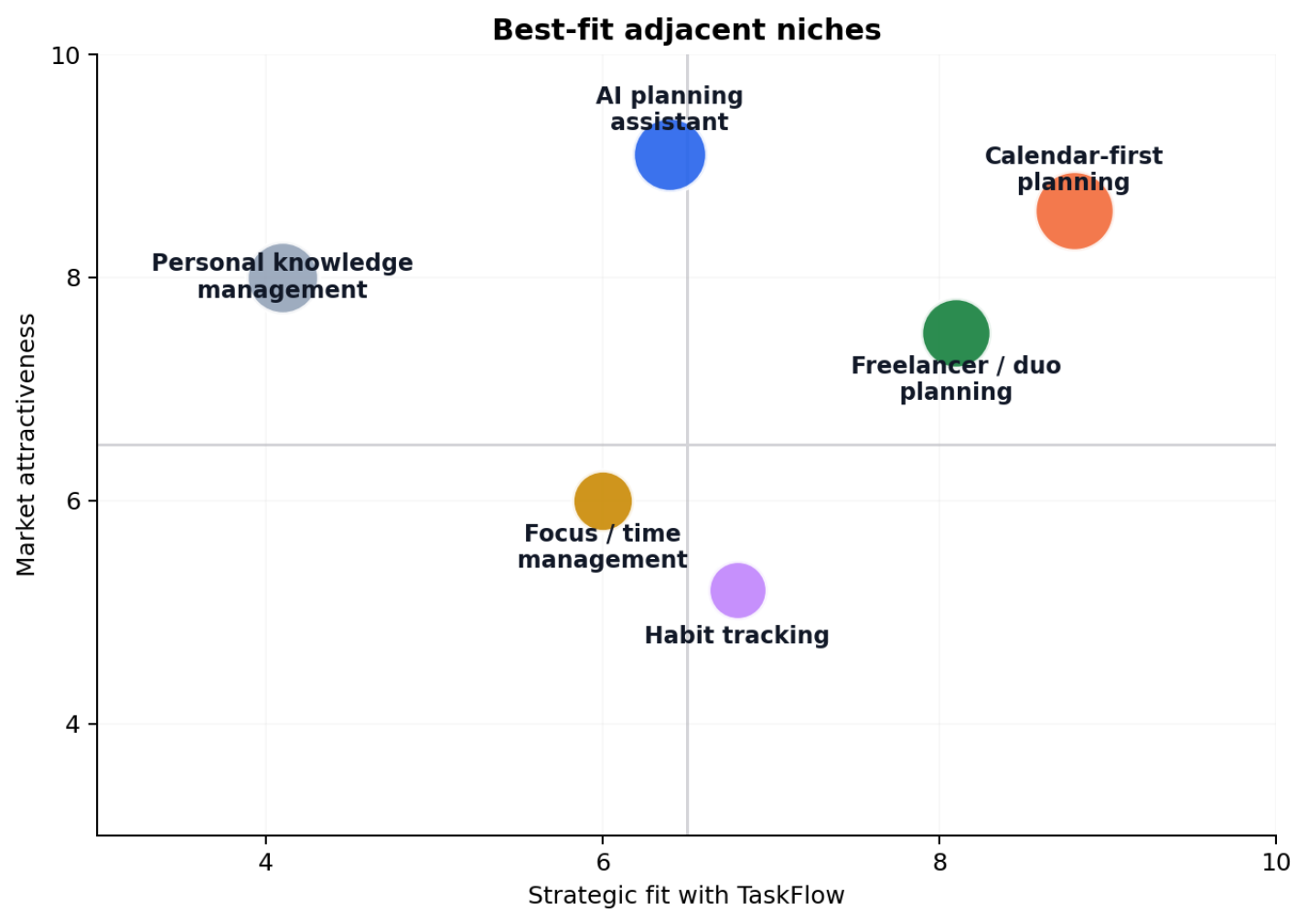
Task management is still growing. The question is not whether demand exists, but where TaskFlow can still win.

The best growth pocket

A narrower calendar-first planning use case fits the product better than generic to-do positioning.

Where to focus first

US, UK, Canada and Australia already drive most revenue. I would fix the product there before chasing cheaper installs elsewhere.



Sources: Mordor Intelligence; TechCrunch on Sensor Tower State of Mobile 2026; Gartner AI predictions.

What stronger players do differently

TaskFlow today

Generic promise, weak collaboration, no offline mode, stale UX, too much paid dependence.

Todoist

Wins on templates, content and integrations. It feels easier to start for a concrete job to be done.

TickTick

Wins on bundled value: tasks, calendar, habits, focus tools and strong annual pricing.

Any.do

Wins on clearer shared-planning packaging through Family and Workspace flows.

Microsoft To Do

Wins distribution through Outlook and the Microsoft ecosystem, not just paid UA.

Lesson: TaskFlow does not need feature parity. It needs one sharper promise and fewer missing basics.

Sources: Todoist, TickTick, Any.do and Microsoft To Do official pages + Google Play listings.

Where TaskFlow still has room to win

1. Faster first value

Onboarding, templates and calendar setup can make the product useful in the first session.

2. Better micro-collaboration

The opening is 2-5 person planning, not complex team workflows.

3. Less paid dependence

Competitors use templates, content, referrals and ecosystems. TaskFlow over-relies on paid social.

4. Product freshness

Shipping visible basics matters. Reviews suggest users no longer trust the product to keep improving.

The growth thesis

TaskFlow should not try to out-feature everyone. The opening is a cleaner calendar-first planner for solo professionals, freelancers and very small shared workflows.

Sources: Competitor public pages and store listings; case prompt review themes.

The strategic choice

Option A | Fix and narrow

Why I would say yes
Attacks the real leak, fits the current team, and can show progress inside 2-3 quarters.

Main downside
Requires discipline to stay narrow.

Option B | Full AI pivot

Why I would hesitate
Attractive theme, but it is a much bigger repositioning with higher product risk, stronger incumbents and extra cost.

Main downside
Too much uncertainty for the current runway.

Option C | Chase cheaper users

Why I would say no for now
It may improve install volume and headline CPI, but it does not solve retention and can weaken the revenue mix.

Main downside
Looks like growth without value.

Why I would pick A

It attacks the real leak fastest, fits the 12-person team, and preserves the option to pivot later if the recovery stalls.

Sources: Own strategic evaluation based on task brief, market data and competitor benchmark.

What turnaround means in practice

Product

Rebuild the activation funnel.
Ship offline mode.
Tighten calendar parity.
Improve onboarding by use case.

Growth

Pause weak paid social.
Rewrite the store listing and landing page.
Build templates and creator pilots.

Customer insight

Run churn interviews.
Tag support tickets by reason.
Add cancellation survey.
Track D7 and D30 by cohort.

Support / success

Use lifecycle nudges for stuck trial users.
Build a self-serve help layer.
Turn support into a feedback loop, not only ticket handling.

Ops / finance

Freeze non-core work.
Use weekly stop-loss rules on paid.
Limit the team to 3 core bets at a time.

The point is not to do more work. It is to do fewer bets with tighter operating discipline.

Sources: Own recommendation based on brief, benchmark and market research.

90 days to stop the bleed, 12 months to scale winners

Q2 2026 | Stop the bleed

Activation funnel
Offline mode MVP
Store listing rewrite
Paid stop-loss rules

Q3 2026 | Prove the core

Collaboration 2.0
Calendar parity
Templates
Free / trial experiments

Q4 2026 | Add AI selectively

Smart scheduling
Natural-language capture
Weekly planning summary

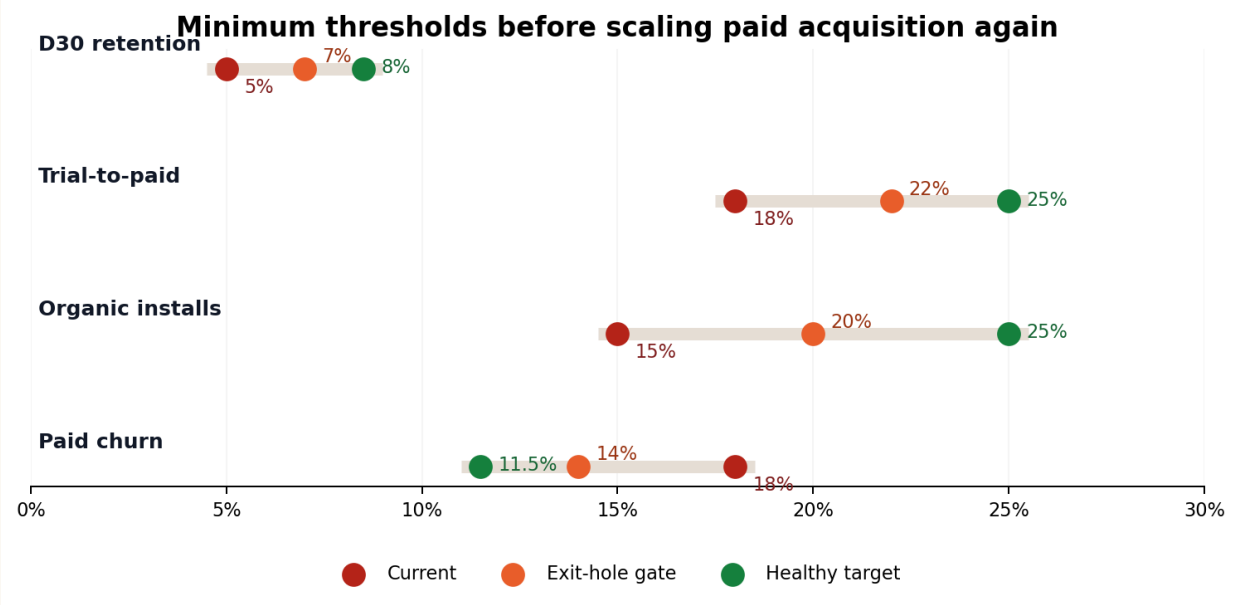
Q1 2027 | Scale winners

Increase spend only on green channels
Referral engine
Wave-2 market tests

Hard checkpoint: if D30 is still below 7% by the end of Q3, revisit a broader pivot instead of raising spend.

Sources: Own roadmap recommendation.

Do not scale again until these thresholds are met



Why these gates matter

They force the team to prove product value before buying more top-of-funnel volume.

Minimum economic rule

Paid LTV / CAC should move above about 1.3x before spend increases materially; healthy state is 1.5x or better.

Scale rule

All operating gates should clear for 2 consecutive months before paid budgets go back up.

Sources: Own thresholds built from current baselines and simplified unit economics.

If the plan works, the business should feel different

User value

D30 is back above 8%, ratings recover, and complaints about missing basics start fading.

Growth quality

Organic share rises, paid dependence falls, and channel decisions get cleaner.

Revenue quality

Lower churn and better trial conversion lift MRR without forcing a risky price cut.

Team cadence

Product, growth and support work from the same weekly scorecard instead of chasing disconnected fixes.

Strategic option value

Management can either keep compounding the recovery or pivot later from a position of strength, not panic.

Sources: Own risk assessment.

Selected sources

Sources (titles)

1. Mordor Intelligence - task management market
2. TechCrunch on Sensor Tower State of Mobile 2026
3. Todoist template gallery
4. Todoist pricing update 2025
5. TickTick upgrade page
6. TickTick ambassador program
7. Any.do pricing and Spaces
8. Microsoft To Do with Outlook Tasks

Links

https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/task-management-software-market
https://techcrunch.com/2026/01/21/consumers-spent-more-on-mobile-apps-than-games-in-2025-driven-by-ai-app-adoption/
https://www.todoist.com/templates/getting-things-done
https://www.todoist.com/help/articles/todoist-pricing-and-plans-update-2025-everything-you-need-to-know-Tn6Pg1JKI
https://ticktick.com/upgrade
https://ticktick.com/ambassador_program
https://www.any.do/pricing

Closing thought

This version is intentionally more operator-style: what to fix, where growth can come from, and what thresholds need to move before scaling again.

Sources: Official market and competitor pages used in the revised deck.